Triage and Risk Assessment

Metric	Result	Calculated Rate	Risk Interpretation	Control Failure
Emails Opened	8/10	80%	High susceptibility to engaging with suspicious emails.	Security Awareness Training is ineffective.Limited caution when handling unexpected emails.
Links Clicked	6/10	60%	Several participants interacted with a suspicious link.	Email filtering may be ineffective.Weak phishing detection and URL verification.
Credentials Submitted	0/10	0%	No data submissions were recorded	No observed submission related failure.
Emails sent	10/10	100%	Most participants engaged with the simulated email.	No direct control failure, baseline metric.
Emails reported	2/10	20%	Few participants reported the simulated email	Weak awareness of phishing reporting procedures.
Landing page visits	6/10	60%	Participants proceeded to the simulated landing page.	Insufficient website legitimacy verification.

The results indicate weaknesses in phishing awareness, particularly in suspicious-link identification and incident reporting. The 60% click rate suggests that participants may be vulnerable to phishing attempts, while the 20% reporting rate highlights the need to strengthen reporting procedures.

Recommended controls:

- Conduct regular cybersecurity awareness training.
- Introduce practical phishing recognition exercises.
- Establish clear email-reporting procedures.
- Monitor reporting and click rates through periodic assessments.

Executive Summary & Recommendations

To: CISO, Head of HR, and Executive Management
From: GRC Audit Team
Date: 4th of November 2026
Subject: Results of Q3 Controlled Phishing Simulation and Human Risk Assessment

1. Executive Summary

This report presents the findings of a controlled phishing simulation conducted using GoPhish to assess participants' awareness of phishing emails, their ability to identify suspicious links, and their knowledge of incident reporting procedures. A total of 10 simulated emails were sent, providing an opportunity to evaluate how participants interacted with the email and the associated landing page.The results revealed significant gaps in phishing awareness and email security practices. Of the 10 emails sent, 8 were opened, representing an 80% open rate. Furthermore, 6 participants clicked the simulated phishing link, resulting in a 60% click rate, while the same number visited the landing page. Only 2 participants reported the simulated email, representing a 20% reporting rate. No credential submissions were recorded.

The findings suggest that participants demonstrate limited caution when interacting with unexpected emails, particularly when assessing suspicious links and determining whether an email should be reported. Although no credentials were submitted, the high click rate indicates a potential exposure to phishing-related threats. The absence of credential submissions is a positive outcome, but it does not eliminate the underlying awareness gaps.

Overall, the simulation highlights the need to strengthen the organization's human-factor security controls through continuous cybersecurity awareness training, practical phishing recognition exercises, clearly defined reporting procedures, and periodic assessments. Implementing these measures will help improve users' ability to recognize, avoid, and report phishing attempts, thereby reducing the organization's exposure to social engineering attacks.

2. Key Findings & Metrics

The simulation produced the following results

Metric	Result	Calculated Rate	Risk Interpretation
Emails Opened	8/10	80%	High susceptibility to engaging with suspicious emails.
Links Clicked	6/10	60%	Several participants interacted with a suspicious link.

Credentials Submitted	0/10	0%	No data submissions were recorded
Emails sent	10/10	100%	Most participants engaged with the simulated email.
Emails reported	2/10	20%	Few participants reported the simulated email
Landing page visits	6/10	60%	Participants proceeded to the simulated landing page.

Major observations:

- The 80% open rate indicates considerable engagement with the simulated email.
- The 60% click rate highlights weaknesses in suspicious-link identification.
- The 20% reporting rate suggests limited awareness of phishing-reporting procedures.
- The 0% credential submission rate indicates that no credential submission was observed during the exercise.

3. Risk Analysis

Identified Risk	likelihood	impact	Risk level
Phishing email engagement	High	Increased exposure to social engineering attacks.	High
Suspicious-link interaction	High	Potential redirection to malicious websites or exposure to harmful content.	High
Weak incident reporting	High	Delayed detection and response to phishing attempts.	High

The most significant concern is the combination of a high click rate and low reporting rate. These findings suggest that participants may not consistently recognize suspicious email indicators or understand the appropriate steps to take when encountering potentially malicious messages.

4. Recommended Actions

To address the identified weaknesses, the following actions are recommended:

Recommended action	Purpose	Expected outcome
Conduct regular cybersecurity awareness training	Improve understanding of phishing techniques and social engineering	Better recognition of suspicious emails.
Introduce practical phishing recognition exercises.	Allow participants to practice identifying suspicious email indicators in controlled exercises.	Reduced phishing click rates.
Establish clear email-reporting procedures	Make it easier for participants to report suspicious messages.	Increased reporting rates and faster incident detection.
Provide targeted training for participants who clicked the simulated link.	Address specific awareness gaps identified during the exercise.	Improved individual phishing resilience
Conduct periodic phishing assessments	Measure changes in user behaviour over time.	Continuous improvement in security awareness.

5. Conclusion

The GoPhish simulation identified notable weaknesses in phishing awareness, particularly in suspicious-ink recognition and incident reporting. While no credentials were submitted, the 60% click rate and 20% reporting rate demonstrate that further improvements are necessary.

A screenshot of the GoPhish campaign results dashboard.

